ENSIGN SERVICES

POSTette: The Updated Plan of Care (UPOC)

Reference: Rehabilitation P&P Policy 240 & 225 & 220; Medicare Benefit Manual Chapters 8 & 11

Therapy services must be directly and specifically related to an active written treatment plan that is based upon an initial evaluation performed by a clinician. **Refer to Rehabilitation P&P 225 Physician Certification of Therapy POC & 240 Updated POC for additional information.**

The clinician will establish an Updated Plan of Care (UPOC) when:

1. The original/prior POC has expired and an new plan of care is required to continue skilled services
2. There are any significant changes/ modification or additions to the previously listed diagnoses other than DX coding errors.
3. There are any changes/modifications or additions to the previously documented long term goal(s)
4. There are significant changes to patient's condition that requires the adjustment of interventions
5. There is a need for an on-going change to frequency.
6. Any time the Re-Evaluation Code is logged. **Note**: A formal re-evaluation is NOT required to update a UPOC that continues with the same course of treatment.

Note: UPOC **would not be required** to adjust procedures, modalities or frequencies (in a single week) that result from a normal progression in the patient's disease or condition or adjustments to the plan due to lack of expected response to the planned intervention, when the goals remain unchanged.

Note: Remember to "uncheck" the original evaluation CPT code on the UPOC so it doesn't carry over onto the new UPOC.

The Updated Plan of Care Purpose:
A UPOC summarizes the need for **continued** skilled intervention using the data from the original evaluation, original POC, and weekly progress reports, in order to establish why continued services are reasonable and necessary.

- The UPOC must be established, committed to writing, completed and signed by the clinician prior to expiration of the prior POC and/or when any material changes are made.
- To avoid not being able to log treatment during the period between the expiration of prior POC and completion of the new UPOC, the UPOC should be completed prior to the expiration of the current POC
- The UPOC must be completed prior to treatment being performed or logged by any clinician or assistant.
- A POC/UPOC may be unlocked after being completed and e-signed by the original completing clinician to make a correction related to a clerical or omission error. Examples: Wrong cert date (start or end or both); wrong diagnostic code(s), but same Medical Condition; Wrong or missing HCPCS/CPT that was intended; wrong frequency.
- The original completing clinician unlocking the POC/UPOC to make the corrections must ensure the following:
    - The corrected POC/UPOC is then e-signed, sent back out to the Physician for signature and date so that the POC/UPOC used for billing has the most up to date corrections
    - The clarification order must match the POC/UPOC
    - The correction MUST BE COMPLETED PRIOR TO TRIPLE CHECK AND/OR PATIENT DISCHARGE FROM SKILLED SERVICE, including Discharge from the facility. The POC must be updated (UPOC) by a clinician prior to the expiration of the original certification AND prior to any treatment being provided by any clinician or assistant.
- A UPOC is used for Recertification to continue beyond the original cert period. A telephone order cannot take the place of a UPOC.
- Physician/NPP signatures are required within 30 days for all Medicare A, Medicare Advantage and Medicare B payer plans for all POC and UPOCs. Follow company standards for late certs if signatures obtained after 30 days.
- **A physician clarification order** also further supports the UPOC.

Completing the UPOC:
The UPOC is the clinician's opportunity to describe **why** skilled intervention **continues to be indicated** and **how** the patient will **benefit from additional therapy**. Each discipline involved is required to establish their own UPOC that ties back to the discipline specific evaluations, prior POCs and weekly progress reports.

Goals
A large part of the plan of care includes establishment of long and short-term goals specifically addressing the impairments identified during the evaluation. Most ongoing UPOCs will have changes to STG. Modifications to LTGs may require a UPOC prior than the expiration date on the active POC.

Justification
Skilled intervention is an opportunity to improve a patient's quality of life. Choose frequencies and durations that are reasonable to demonstrate progress and is supported by evidence-based practice

©Copyright 2016 Ensign Services, Inc.